
SGGHS 2020 MODERN HISTORY TRIAL PAPER QUESTIONS

POWER AND AUTHORITY IN THE MODERN WORLD 1919-1946

1. Outline the conditions that enable dictators to rise to power in the interwar period. (3 marks)
2. How does Source A reflect the initial consolidation of Nazi power 1933-1934? (4 marks)
3. What is the value of Source B for understanding the nature of Nazi ideology? (6 marks)
4. To what extent was the rise of Hitler and the Nazi Party the reason for the collapse of the Weimar Republic? (12 marks)

NATIONAL STUDIES: RUSSIA AND THE SOVIET UNION 1917-1941

- a) To what extent does Stalin's domination of the party structure account for his emergence as leader of the USSR by the late 1920s?
- b) To what extent did Stalin bring about economic and social transformation in the Soviet Unions in the period to 1941?

PEACE AND CONFLICT: CONFLICT IN THE PACIFIC

- a) To what extent was Japan responsible for the outbreak of war in the Pacific in 1941?
- b) What was the most significant reason for the Japanese defeat? Provide reasons for your answer.

PEACE AND CONFLICT: CONFLICT IN EUROPE 1935-1945

- a) To what extent was Germany responsible for the outbreak of war in Europe in 1939?
- b) What was the most significant turning point of the conflict in Europe? Provide reasons for your answer.

CHANGE IN THE MODERN WORLD: THE CULTURAL REVOLUTION TO TIANAMEN SQUARE 1966-1989

- a) Outline THREE legacies the 1949 Revolution had on political and social conditions in China. (3 marks)
- b) Explain the souring of Sino-Soviet relations after the death of Stalin. (5 marks)
- c) What were the main aims of Mao Zedong in starting the Cultural Revolution? (7 marks)
- d) How significant was the Gang of Four to Mao's Cultural Revolution? (10 marks)

CHANGE IN THE MODERN WORLD: CIVIL RIGHTS IN THE USA 1945-1968

- a) Outline THREE ways in which World War II had an impact on the circumstances of African Americans. (3 marks)
- b) Explain some of the way African Americans experienced racial discrimination during the 1940's and 1950's. (5 marks)
- c) What were the main methods employed by civil rights movements in the United States across the period? (7 marks)
- d) How significant was Martin Luther King to the civil rights movement up to 1968? (10 marks)

Source A

Burning of the Reichstag building in Berlin, February 1933



Source B

Selected translated extracts from the Document 1708-PS of the Nazi Party, The Program of the NSDAP, also known as The 25 Points, proclaimed by the leader of the party, Hitler, on 24 February 1920

The program is the political foundation of the NSDAP and accordingly the primary political law of the State. It has been made brief and clear intentionally. All legal precepts [rules] must be applied in the spirit of the party program...

...Within the national socialist philosophy is summarized in 25 points:

1. We demand the unification of all Germans in the Greater Germany on the basis of the right of self-determination of peoples.
2. We demand equality of rights for the German people in respect to the other nations; abrogation [repeal/abolition] of the peace treaty of Versailles...
3. We demand land and territory (colonies) for the sustenance of our people, and colonization for our surplus population.
4. Only a member of the race can be a citizen. A member of the race can only be one who is of German blood, without consideration of creed. Consequently no Jew can be a member of the race...

...10. The first obligation of every citizen must be to work both spiritually and physically. The activity of individuals is not to counteract the interests of the universality, but must have its result within the framework of the whole for the benefit of all...

...25. For the execution of all of this we demand the formation of a strong central power in the Reich. Unlimited authority of the central parliament over the whole Reich and its organizations in general...

The leaders of the Party promise, if necessary by sacrificing their own lives, to support by the execution of the points set forth above without consideration.

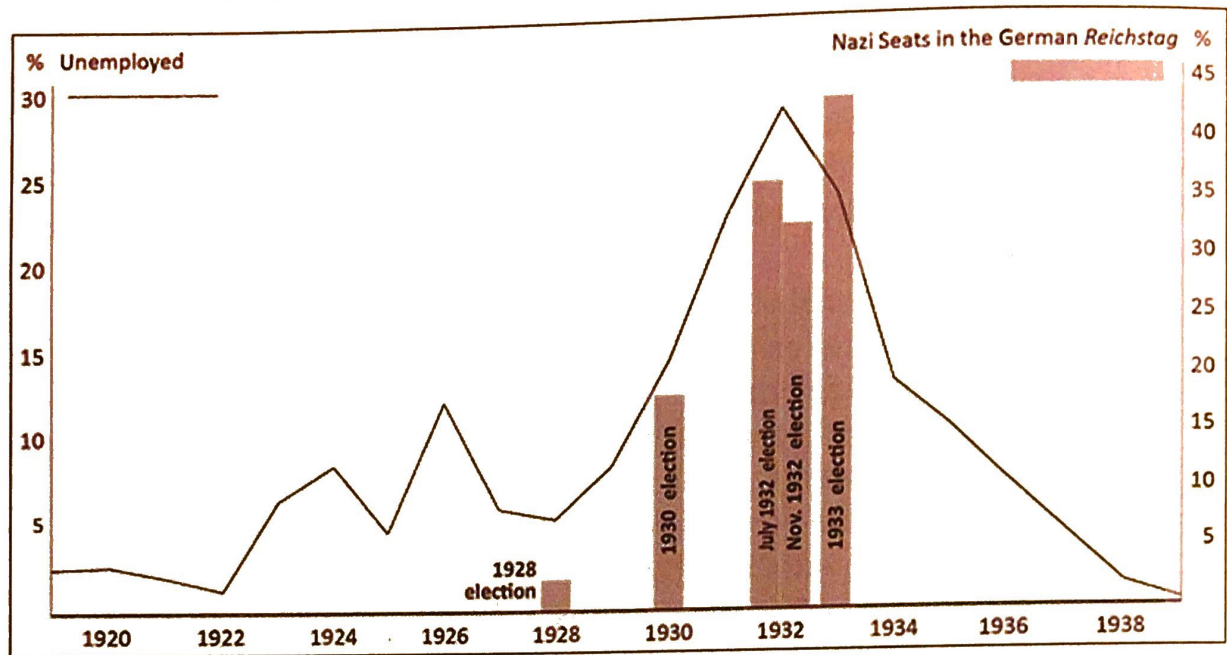
Source C

Extract from Eric D. Weitz, Weimar Germany: Promise and Tragedy, 2018

There were flaws [in the Weimar Constitution]... [it] had no stirring preamble that laid out a vision of a democratic Germany. The proportional voting system contributed mightily to the political fragmentation of Weimar. The electoral law that followed [the constitution] authorised representation in the Reichstag for every party with 60,000 votes. The powers granted to the president in emergency situations were too extensive. But the flaws in the constitution had less to do with the political system it established than with the fact that German society was so fragmented. A less divided society, and one with a more expansive commitment to democratic principles, could have made it work.

Source D

German unemployment figures and Nazi results in German elections



Source E

Adolf Hitler greets President Paul von Hindenburg on March 21, 1933 in Potsdam, Germany



Source F

Nazi Party Presidential election poster from 1932

'Men!

Women!

*Millions of men without work. Millions of children without a future.
Save the German family. Vote for Adolf Hitler!'*

